TOPIC REPORTS: LEGISLATION AND REGULATION

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

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Algeria

DIGITALISATION LAW

- **الرقمنة في الجزائر.. شفافية وعصرنة (Digitalisation in Algeria: transparency and modernisation)** — الشعب أونلاين (Echaab Online), 20 September 2026

  A dossier in Algeria's Echaab newspaper on 20 September 2026 reviews the High Commission for Digitalisation's work since April 2024: a national digital transformation strategy published in May 2025, a national cloud and certified data centres, the IRIES secure network linking ministries, cybersecurity and network operations centres, and the national digital services centre opened in July 2026. It says a digitalisation law is in the final stages of study.

DRAFT 2027 FINANCE LAW, E-PAYMENT AND DIGITAL-PLATFORM PROVISIONS

- **Projet de loi de finances 2027: Des avantages fiscaux pour booster le E-paiement** — L'Echo d'Algérie, 11 October 2026

  Algeria's draft 2027 finance law proposes a 10% tax reduction until the end of 2028 for flat-rate and professional taxpayers who take at least half their receipts electronically. It would also require resident and non-resident e-commerce platforms to register with the tax authority and declare transactions yearly, on pain of a DA 1 million fine. The bill is not yet adopted.

- **L'Algérie prévoit de soumettre les plateformes numériques étrangères à de nouvelles obligations de TVA en 2027** — Algerian Business, 12 October 2026

  Algeria's draft 2027 finance law proposes that foreign digital platforms selling services to customers in Algeria register with the tax authority, keep records for ten years and declare and pay VAT quarterly. Non-compliance would carry a fine of 5 million dinars after 30 days' notice and possible suspension of access to the platform. The provision is a draft, not yet adopted.

Angola

NATIONAL STATISTICAL SYSTEM LAW

- **INE inicia recolha de contribuições para nova Lei Estatística** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 29 September 2026

  Angola's statistics institute opened a public consultation, running to 2 October, on a revision of the national statistics law and a new national strategy for the development of statistics.

CYBERSECURITY BILL

- **Nova Lei da Cibersegurança impõe registo e notificação de incidentes a operadores** — PTI, 2 October 2026

  Angola's cybersecurity law has been published as Lei n.º 9/26 of 28 September and is in force, revoking the 2017 law. Operators of critical infrastructure, essential services, electronic communications, data centres and cloud services must register with the National Cybersecurity Centre within 180 days, set up incident response teams and notify significant incidents to CERT.ao.

ELECTRONIC SIGNATURE AND CERTIFICATION REGIME

- **João Lourenço recebe autorização para estabelecer regime da assinatura electrónica** — PTI, 8 October 2026

  Angola's Law 12/26 of 2 October authorises the President to legislate the regime for electronic signatures and digital certification and the rules of the national public key infrastructure, within 90 days.

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY CENTRE

- **MINTTICS apresenta Estratégia Nacional de Cibersegurança no CyberSecur Summit 2026** — PTI, 12 October 2026

  Angola's telecommunications ministry presented the National Cybersecurity Strategy, approved by Presidential Decree 256/25 of 3 December 2025, at the CyberSecur Summit in Luanda on 12 October 2026. Policy director Hecdiantro Mena said a national commission will be formed to prepare, within 180 days, the conditions for setting up the National Cybersecurity Centre. No budget is given.

Benin

DIGITAL CODE ARTICLE 550 ON HARASSMENT THROUGH ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS

- **CPJ letter to President Wadagni: press freedom concerns in Benin** — Committee to Protect Journalists, 1 September 2026

  The Committee to Protect Journalists wrote to President Wadagni 100 days into his term asking that Benin's Digital Code stop being used against the press and that its Article 550 on electronic harassment be reformed. The letter cites the continued detention of two online journalists, prison sentences over Facebook posts after the December 2025 coup attempt, and repeated suspensions imposed by the media regulator HAAC.

LOI 2017-20 PORTANT CODE DU NUMERIQUE

- **Société : Votre patron peut-il lire vos messages WhatsApp professionnels ?** — La Nation, 5 September 2026

  Benin's La Nation explains how the country's Digital Code limits employers' access to staff WhatsApp messages. Owning a work phone or computer does not give an employer the right to read personal conversations; monitoring of accounts used only for work must serve a work purpose and follow the code's personal data rules, including article 379.

AUTHORISATION OF ONLINE MEDIA BY THE AUDIOVISUAL REGULATOR

- **Régulation des médias en ligne: 89 organes autorisés par la Haac** — La Nation, 2 October 2026

Benin's media regulator HAAC signed conventions with 89 online media outlets in Cotonou on 1 October 2026, completing its authorisation process for websites offering online audiovisual and written-press services. The outlets now operate under the information and communication code and the digital code.

Burkina Faso

DECREE ON CONSULAR CIVIL-STATUS POWERS AND CIVIL STATUS OF CITIZENS ABROAD

- **Conseil des ministres n26 du 10 septembre 2026** — Radiodiffusion Television du Burkina, 10 September 2026

  Burkina Faso's Council of Ministers, meeting in Bobo-Dioulasso on 10 September 2026, adopted a decree on the civil-status powers of diplomatic and consular agents, replacing a 1963 decree. It adds deputy heads of mission as civil-status officers, allows delegation, including exceptionally to honorary consuls, and introduces mobile consular missions for citizens living far from a consulate.

Burundi

ORDONNANCE MINISTERIELLE N 540/906/2026 ON SIM REGISTRATION

- **Burundi SIM registration process faces challenges, scams persist** — Connecting Africa, 2 October 2026

  Burundi's mandatory SIM and eSIM registration, begun in mid-June, was about 70 per cent complete on the regulator's count. Users report long queues, few service points and slow systems, and scams continue; operators must keep customer data for at least five years.

Cameroon

LOI N. 2010/012 ON CYBERCRIME AND CYBERSECURITY

- **Cybersecurity as Industrial Policy: Protecting Cameroon's Digital Economy** — Nkafu Policy Institute, 4 September 2026

  A Nkafu Policy Institute brief argues that Cameroon should treat cybersecurity as industrial policy under its 2020–2030 development strategy. It cites a 156% rise in cyberattacks between 2020 and 2023, over $45m in fraud losses, 333,930 vulnerability-exploiting attacks in 2024, and 32,500 cybercrime legal requests handled by the ICT agency ANTIC in 2025. It describes the 2010 cyber law as outdated.

PUBLIC DIRECTORY OF LICENSED TELECOMMUNICATIONS OPERATORS

- **Cameroon tightens grip on telecoms** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  Cameroon's Telecommunications Regulatory Board is compiling a public directory of licensed operators and has told every operator to complete an identification form on its website. The board says the directory will let consumers verify which companies are licensed, expose fraudulent operators and help agencies identify legitimate players.

- **Cameroon TRB Updates Telecom Operators Directory to Strengthen Transparency** — Tech Africa News, 17 September 2026

  Cameroon's telecommunications regulator gave operators until 30 September 2026 to file identification forms for a public directory that is to separate licensed and compliant providers from unlicensed ones. Nothing is yet published and no publication date for the directory itself is stated.

Central African Republic

STATISTICS LAW AND ITS REPLACEMENT

- **ICASEES : Evaluation à mi-parcours de la deuxième Stratégie Nationale de Développement de la Statistique** — ICASEES, 10 October 2026

  The Central African Republic's statistics institute ICASEES held a mid-term review of the second national statistics strategy (2024–2028) in Bangui from 7 to 9 October 2026, funded entirely by the UN Development Programme. The strategy, adopted in August 2023 with a budget of nearly 60 billion CFA francs, is to be updated; a bill replacing the 2001 statistics law has passed technical validation and awaits review by the official-texts commission.

Chad

CEMAC PAYMENT SYSTEMS REGULATION AS CHAD'S OPERATIVE PAYMENTS LAW

- **Instructions, Circulaires et Règlements — Banque des États de l'Afrique Centrale** — Banque des États de l'Afrique Centrale (BEAC), 2 September 2026

  The Bank of Central African States' register of payment-system instruments lists the CEMAC rules that apply in Chad: Regulation 03 of 21 December 2016 on payment systems, means and incidents, and Regulation 04 of 21 December 2018 on payment services. It also lists a 2018 instruction on interoperability and a 2025 instruction adopting the ISO 20022 standard for payments.

LOI 026/PR/2019 ORGANISING STATISTICAL ACTIVITY

- **Politique d'accès — Archive Nationale des Données du Tchad (ANAD)** — Institut National de la Statistique, des Études Économiques et Démographiques (INSEED), République du Tchad, 2 September 2026

  Chad's national statistics institute, INSEED, sets the access conditions for microdata in its National Data Archive (ANAD). Users must keep respondents anonymous under the 2019 statistics law, may not copy or pass the data to others without INSEED's written consent, must cite a prescribed source line and must send INSEED two copies of any resulting report.

- **TEXTES RÉGLEMENTAIRES — INSEED-TCHAD** — Institut National de la Statistique, des Études Économiques et Démographiques (INSEED), République du Tchad, 2 September 2026

  Chad's national statistics institute, INSEED, lists the legal basis of the national statistical system: Law No. 026/PR/2019 of June 2019, which makes INSEED the system's central body with legal personality and management autonomy, and four application decrees of July 2019. The system also includes a statistics development fund, a national statistics council, sectoral statistical units and a statistics school.

DRAFT LABOUR CODE COVERING DIGITAL PLATFORM WORKERS

- **Travail : le Tchad change les règles entre employé et employeur** — Le N'Djam Post, 11 September 2026

  Chad's Council of Ministers adopted on 3 September 2026 a draft Labour Code replacing the 1996 law. Platform workers are presumed to be employees where at least two criteria of subordination are met, platforms must be more open about the algorithms that direct work, and social security cover is extended. The draft also raises the end-of-contract payment on fixed-term contracts from 5% to 7%.

Congo

LAW NO. 8-2001 ON FREEDOM OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION

- **Sicom 2026 : nécessité de faire progresser le cadre juridique des médias au Congo** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 September 2026

Opening the first Sicom media fair in Brazzaville on 17 September 2026, the Republic of Congo's prime minister, Anatole Collinet Makosso, said the 2001 law on freedom of information and communication must be updated for social networks, disinformation and artificial intelligence. No draft bill or timetable was announced.

- **Sicom 2026 : un bilan et des engagements pour l'avenir** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 21 September 2026

  Congo's first information, communication and media fair closed at Kintélé on 19 September 2026 with 23 resolutions from participants. They call for rewriting the three core media laws to take account of digital broadcasting, online platforms and AI, and cover digital content, advertising and tax. These are recommendations from the profession, not government decisions.

FINANCE LAW 2026, ARTICLE 13: REGISTRATION AND DECLARATION OF MONEY TRANSFERS

- **Congo/Finances : Jean Claude Bazebi déterminé à assurer la transparence dans le secteur des transferts de fonds** — Agence Congolaise d'information (ACI), 7 October 2026

  The Republic of the Congo's money transfer regulator, ARTF, said on 5 October 2026 it will enforce article 13 of the 2026 finance law, which requires every money transfer operator to register on its digital platform and declare all transfers. Operators refusing to connect face a fine of 20 million FCFA. Electronic terminals will go first to Brazzaville and Pointe-Noire.

- **Transfert de fonds : l'usage des terminaux de paiement électronique entrera en vigueur dès janvier 2027** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 8 October 2026

  Congo's money-transfer regulator ARTF will require every money-transfer operator to use electronic payment terminals from January 2027, as the finance law provides, Les Dépêches de Brazzaville reported on 8 October 2026. The terminals record each transaction in real time for tax purposes; 200 of 1,000 ordered were shown to about a hundred transfer and exchange operators in Brazzaville.

Cote d'Ivoire

NET NEUTRALITY GUIDELINES

- **Consultation publique relative à l'élaboration des lignes directrices en vue de la mise en œuvre de la neutralité du Net en Côte d'Ivoire (contribution Moov Africa CI, publiée par l'ARTCI)** — ARTCI, 1 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's regulator ARTCI consulted on draft net-neutrality guidelines from 6 July to 6 August 2026 and published operators' responses in September. The draft allows zero rating only where it is unpaid and non-discriminatory, and would have internet providers declare their traffic-management practices each year; Moov Africa argued that strict non-discrimination would slow 5G services.

BANKING REGULATION BILL BRINGING FINANCIAL TECHNOLOGY FIRMS INTO THE PERIMETER

- **Reforme bancaire : La Cote d'Ivoire redessine la frontiere avec les fintechs** — CADRECO, 10 September 2026

  Cote d'Ivoire's banking reform folds digital finance into a wider legal architecture in which competition between banks, payment institutions, electronic money issuers, fintechs, Islamic finance and microfinance turns on licences, their obligations and their cost. The Council of Ministers adopted two bills in April as part of it.

REVISION OF THE 2013 POSTAL CODE (LOI 2013-702)

- **Côte d'Ivoire-AIP/ L'ARTCI mise sur l'innovation pour transformer le réseau postal en levier de développement** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse (AIP), 9 October 2026

The director general of Côte d'Ivoire's telecoms regulator, ARTCI, Lakoun Ouattara, said on World Post Day, 9 October 2026, that the postal network should adapt to e-commerce, digital addressing and last-mile delivery. He said the 2013 Postal Code, law 2013-702, is being revised to cover new uses and operators. No timetable for the revision is given.

DR Congo

ORDONNANCES-LOIS ORGANISING STATISTICAL ACTIVITY

- **Le Président Tshisekedi fixe les conditions d'organisation de l'activité statistique en RDC - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo's President Félix Tshisekedi signed an ordinance-law organising statistical activity, the 98th Council of Ministers reported on 11 September 2026. It governs the production, dissemination and archiving of official statistics and national censuses, names the Institut national de la statistique as principal statistical authority, and applies its confidentiality rules at once to operations under way.

- **RDC : le gouvernement adopte le projet de loi autorisant la ratification du nouveau cadre de l'activité statistique** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's Council of Ministers on 11 September 2026 adopted a bill to ratify the ordinance-law organising official statistics, submitted by the planning minister. The law sets principles of professional independence and statistical confidentiality, and bars use of data collected for statistics for control, prosecution or sanctions outside cases the law provides.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON NON-CONSENSUAL DIFFUSION OF INTIMATE CONTENT

- **Violence numérique : une proposition de loi de protection des victimes annoncée à Kinshasa - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  Christelle Vuanga, a member of the Democratic Republic of Congo's National Assembly, announced she will table a bill this parliamentary session amending the penal code and the 2023 digital code to protect victims of non-consensual sharing of intimate images. She proposes prison terms of five to ten years with fines, and heavier penalties where blackmail or minors are involved.

DÉCRET 23/13 CREATING THE SUCCESSOR REGULATOR ARPTIC

- **[Enquête]- ARPTC, un policier illégal et défaillant** — Ouragan.cd, 14 September 2026

  A joint press investigation calls DR Congo's telecoms regulator ARPTC unlawful and ineffective, noting that the successor authority created by a 2023 decree has never been installed. It details failings on service quality and equipment approval.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON THE PROTECTION OF MINORS IN THE DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT

- **Assemblée nationale: le député Alfred Dibandi initie une proposition de loi relative à la protection des mineurs dans l'environnement numérique** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

  Alfred Dibandi Nzondomyo, a national deputy in the Democratic Republic of Congo, filed a private member's bill on protecting minors in the digital environment on 21 September 2026. He said it complements the Digital Code and child-protection law, with rules by age band for under-6s, under-11s and under-15s. The bill's text has not been published.

BILL AMENDING THE CODE DU NUMÉRIQUE ON MINORS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **DRC Senate Considers Social Media Ban for Children Under 13** — We Are Tech, 1 October 2026

The DR Congo Senate declared admissible on 28 September 2026 a bill by Senator Yvan Kazadi Kankonde amending the 2023 Digital Code to bar children under 13 from opening social media accounts. Those aged 13 to 15 would need verifiable parental consent, and platforms would have to verify age. The bill has gone to committee and is not law.

Egypt

FINANCIAL REGULATORY AUTHORITY TECHNOLOGY SANDBOX

- **Egypt's FRA Approves Two New Fintech Projects for Regulatory Sandbox** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  Egypt's Financial Regulatory Authority granted preliminary approval for two further projects to enter its regulatory sandbox for non-banking financial technology.

ONE-TIME-PASSWORD IDENTITY VERIFICATION IN CONSUMER AND MSME FINANCE

- **الرقابة المالية تلزم شركات التمويل باستخدام رمز التحقق OTP خلال شهرين** — Maspero (National Media Authority), 14 September 2026

  Egypt's Financial Regulatory Authority issued Decision 2735 of 2026, giving consumer finance and small-business finance companies two months to introduce one-time password verification of customers. A code must be sent to the customer's verified phone number when a finance contract is signed and when the finance is drawn, and the lender must keep a record of it.

JOINT PRIOR OVERSIGHT OF NON-BANK FINANCIAL APPLICATIONS

- **بروتوكول بين "الأعلى للإعلام" و"الرقابة المالية" لتعزيز رقابة تطبيقات أسواق المالية غير المصرفية** — Youm7, 16 September 2026

  Egypt's Supreme Council for Media Regulation and the Financial Regulatory Authority signed a protocol on 16 September 2026 on oversight of apps and platforms in the non-bank financial markets. Before licensing any app that uses the names of FRA-supervised firms or carries on such activity, the council must obtain the authority's technical opinion, due within 15 days.

COMPREHENSIVE DIGITAL-SAFETY LAW

- **تنظيم الاتصالات»: حجب منصات التواصل في مصر حال مخالفة ضوابط حماية الأطفال«** — Fintechgate, 18 September 2026

  Egypt's National Telecom Regulatory Authority said social media platforms that fail to comply with new child-protection rules could be suspended and blocked in Egypt, whatever their size. Its vice-chairman, Mohamed Ibrahim, said platforms have three months to comply, the rules cover existing accounts of under-15s, and age checks must collect only necessary data.

- **رئيس اتصالات النواب: قانون السلامة الرقمية أولوية بدور الانعقاد الثاني** — Youm7, 4 October 2026

  Ahmed Badawi, newly elected chair of the Egyptian House of Representatives' ICT committee, said a digital safety law tops the committee's agenda for the new session. He said parliament and government coordinated the bill over nine sessions with 14 ministers and that most of its articles regulate children's use of social media. Amendments to the information technology law are also planned.

DIGITAL SAFETY BILL

- **اتصالات النواب: الانتهاء من قانون السلامة الرقمية خلال شهر** — Al-Ahram, 5 October 2026

> Egypt's parliamentary ICT committee chair Ahmed Badawi said the committee will open its new session with the digital safety bill and expects it finished within a month. The bill protects children on social media and adds rules for adults on online betting, defamation and disinformation; the committee held six hearings with 14 ministers and agency heads.

Equatorial Guinea

> TAXATION OF FOREIGN DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **El Gobierno exige a Meta tributar en Guinea Ecuatorial y ordena centralizar la comercialización de Starlink en ORTEL** — AHORAEG, 9 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, gave the state operator ORTEL sole legal authority to sell Starlink satellite internet, under the state secretariat for artificial intelligence, and ordered contracts made outside official channels cancelled. He also tasked a commission with discussing payments to the state with Meta, which he said has done business in the country without paying.

- **Guinée équatoriale : contribution des plateformes numériques en discussion** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea intends a mechanism letting the state capture part of the revenue large digital platforms generate in its market, a question sharpened where companies operate from abroad. The vice-president asked in Malabo for talks to be opened with one such platform and with comparable alternatives.

> PRESS LAW REVISION

- **La Camara de los Diputados ha aprobado tres proyectos de leyes presentados por el Gobierno** — Pagina Oficial del Gobierno de la Republica de Guinea Ecuatorial, 11 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Chamber of Deputies unanimously approved three government bills on 11 September 2026: reforms of the Mining and Hydrocarbons laws and a new press freedom law. The mining reform creates a national geological service, a mining registry and cadastre, a national mining management platform and a digital geological registry, with licences awarded by international tender as the general rule. The press law replaces a 1997 law that does not cover digital journalism.

- **La nueva Ley de Libertad de Prensa avanza al Pleno del Senado tras el consenso alcanzado por la comisión** — AHORAEG, 8 October 2026

  An Equatorial Guinea Senate committee approved by consensus its report on a new Press Freedom and Journalism Bill and sent it to the full Senate. The bill gives digital and audiovisual journalists the same protections and duties, sets a right of access to public information with deadlines and appeals, separates editorial oversight from spectrum management by ORTEL and creates a college of journalists.

> SATELLITE BROADBAND SALES ROUTED THROUGH THE REGULATOR

- **Equatorial Guinea: Starlink sales to run via ORTEL** — Tech.Africa, 15 September 2026

  All satellite internet sales are to run through the telecommunications regulator, under the supervision of the artificial intelligence state secretariat, and contracts citizens obtained outside official channels are to be cancelled, decided at a working session on 9 September.

> LEY 7/2024 ON SOCIAL MEDIA AND COMPUTER CRIME

- **El despacho que representa a S.E. Nguema Obiang Mangue explica las acciones contra Diario Rombe y otras tres personas** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 17 September 2026

Lawyers for Equatorial Guinea's vice-president Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue said they lodged four criminal complaints at a Malabo court on 16 September 2026 against four people, including Mocache Massoko of the online paper Diario Rombe. The complaints rest on articles 2 and 60 of Law 7/2024 on social media and cybercrime; article 2 is invoked to reach conduct outside the country.

Eritrea

BANK OF ERITREA LEGAL NOTICE NO. 134/2026 ON CASH HOLDINGS

- **Eritrea's new cash restrictions** — Martin Plaut, 18 September 2026

  An Eritrean human-rights group reports that a central bank legal notice of 9 September caps the cash an individual may keep beyond 15 days at 25,000 nakfa, with higher limits for businesses, following a June order to deposit cash holdings. It notes that the country has no generally available cash machines or cards and thin branch access outside the main towns.

Eswatini

IMMIGRATION BILL TRAVELLER VETTING SYSTEM

- **New proposed law to screen foreigners entering country** — Times of Eswatini, 10 September 2026

  Eswatini's Immigration Bill would set up an information system to vet foreign nationals before entry and block those who fail requirements or are judged a risk. It was discussed at a consultation between Parliament and stakeholders in Ezulwini. The workshop heard that implementation would cost about E6 million.

Ethiopia

NATIONAL DATA MANAGEMENT PROCLAMATION (DRAFT)

- **Council of Ministers Refers Key Bills to HPR on Governance, Data, Power and Defense** — Ethiopian News Agency (ENA), 28 September 2026

  The state news agency's account of the same Council session names the bill the National Data Governance Draft Proclamation, referred to parliament with the Council's unanimous backing.

- **Ethiopia's Council of Ministers Advances New Legal Frameworks for State Institutions, Data Sovereignty, Defence and Economy** — Fana Media Corporation S.C., 28 September 2026

  Ethiopia's Council of Ministers unanimously sent a draft national data proclamation to parliament, framed around data security and sovereignty, data sharing and interoperability across government, and support for AI research.

Gabon

DRAFT LEGAL TEXTS FOR DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

- **Gabon Begins Validation of Digital Transformation Legal Framework** — Tech Africa News, 2 October 2026

  Gabon began a validation review of draft legal texts for digital transformation at Nkok on 1 October, to run about ten days. The texts cover digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, digital services and the institutional framework, under the World Bank-financed Gabon Digital programme.

ORDONNANCE N 0011/PR/2026 ON SOCIAL-MEDIA USE THROUGH DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Gabon : amendes jusqu'à 50 millions et peines de prison pour les abus commis sur les réseaux sociaux** — Gabon Media Time, 18 October 2026

Gabon promulgated by decree on 5 October 2026 a law ratifying its ordinance on social-network use, Gabon Media Time reported. Hosts or editors who fail to fight illicit content face a year in prison and fines of FCFA 5 million to 50 million, deepfakes are banned, and judges may order platform suspensions of up to 72 hours.

- **Gabon : l'identification formelle des utilisateurs de réseaux sociaux devient obligatoire** — Gabon Media Time, 19 October 2026

  Gabon's law 003/2026 of 5 October 2026, published on 9 October, requires individuals and legal entities using social networks and online platforms to formally identify themselves. Gabon Media Time reports that article 4 does not say what documents are needed, how identity will be checked or how existing accounts are treated. It also does not make the personal identification number mandatory for this purpose.

Gambia

COMPETITION AND CONSUMER PROTECTION COMMISSION BILL 2026

- **Parliament Commits Bill to Prohibit Anti-Competitive Practices - Mansa Banko Online** — Mansa Banko Online, 15 September 2026

  The Gambia's National Assembly took the Competition and Consumer Protection Commission Bill 2026 through second reading on 15 September and sent it to committee. Tabled by trade minister Mod K. Ceesay, it replaces the 2007 competition and 2014 consumer protection Acts, creates an independent commission with powers to investigate and impose penalties, and extends consumer protection to distance selling and digital content.

Ghana

VIRTUAL ASSET SERVICE PROVIDERS ACT 2025

- **Ghana: Technical Assistance Report - Regulation and Supervision of Crypto Markets and Activities (IMF Technical Assistance Report No. 26/78, September 2026)** — International Monetary Fund, Monetary and Capital Markets Department (Parma Bains, Philipp Hochreiter); file as hosted by BitKE, 1 September 2026

  An IMF technical assistance report on Ghana, dated September 2026, found that the crypto guidelines of the Bank of Ghana and the Securities and Exchange Commission fall short of full oversight, ahead of a licensing regime under the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025 due to start in December 2026. It puts annual crypto transactions at about US$21bn and recommends activity-based rules, final stablecoin rules and transitional licensing.

- **Ghana is 5th largest crypto market in sub-Saharan Africa; annual transactions around $21bn** — MyJoyOnline, 30 September 2026

  An International Monetary Fund technical assistance report for the Bank of Ghana and the Securities and Exchange Commission puts Ghana's crypto transactions at about $21 billion a year, with 8% to 17% of the population having traded crypto, reported on 30 September 2026. Ghana passed its Virtual Asset Service Providers Act in December 2025, giving both bodies oversight.

RIGHT TO INFORMATION ACT 2019 (ACT 989)

- **Transparency in words, Secrecy in practice: How MDAs are betraying Gov't's transparency pledge** — The Fourth Estate, 3 September 2026

> The Fourth Estate reported that 21 Ghanaian public institutions failed to release information in 24 Right to Information requests between January 2025 and July 2026. Those named include the Ministry of Finance, the Office of the Attorney-General, the National Communications Authority and the Ghana Highways Authority. Petitions have gone to the RTI Commission, and the Minister for Government Communications said there is no policy of concealment.

> VIRTUAL ASSETS COORDINATING COMMITTEE

- **REGULATION | Ghana Sets Up 5-Agency Committee to Coordinate Virtual Asset Regulation Oversight** — BitKE, 3 September 2026

  Ghana has set up a five-agency Virtual Assets Coordinating Committee, chaired by Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Pandit Asiama, joining the central bank, the Securities and Exchange Commission, the Finance Ministry, the Cyber Security Authority and the Financial Intelligence Centre. Regulators aim to implement the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act, 2025 fully by 2027. Operational rules have not yet been published.

> SIM RE-REGISTRATION LEGISLATIVE INSTRUMENT

- **'The resolve of this Ministry is unshaken' – Sam George on biometric SIM verification** — Asaase Radio, 7 September 2026

  Ghana's communications minister said Parliament has passed the legislative instrument governing SIM registration and the biometric verification phase will be introduced before the end of 2026. The same account puts completion of the 2021–2023 exercise it replaces at 44.28% of subscribers.

- **Ghana's Biometric SIM Plan Fixes the Right Gap, but the Data Safeguards Must Be Written Into the Rules** — People of Internet, 18 October 2026

  In an unsigned analysis, the outlet People of Internet argues that Ghana's plan to add biometric checks to SIM registration addresses a real gap but needs data safeguards written into the rules. It calls for purging legacy data, match-only queries, warrants for police access and a fallback when biometric reads fail. It draws on the communications minister's 7 September 2026 statement.

> INNOVATION AND STARTUP BILL

- **Ghana Moves to Align Digital Entrepreneurship and Innovation Regulatory Framework** — Neo Report Gh, 15 September 2026

  The Smart Africa Secretariat held a validation and roadmap workshop for Ghana under its AEDIB 2.0 programme in Accra on 9 and 10 September 2026, co-hosted by Ghana's science and communications ministries. Participants examined overlaps between a policy in development, a proposed Science and Technology Development Agency Bill and an advisory council not yet operating, and produced a workplan canvas.

Guinea-Bissau

> DATA PROTECTION BILL

- **Côte d'Ivoire-AIP/Inter/ La Cour de justice de la CEDEAO dispose d'un cadre pour statuer sur les droits numériques, selon un universitaire** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse, 23 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  At a Dakar conference, law lecturer Jake Okechukwu Effoduh argued that the ECOWAS Court already has the legal basis to hear digital-rights cases, from internet shutdowns to biometric surveillance, without a new treaty. A Bissau law professor noted that Guinea-Bissau still has no data-protection law or authority, though a bill would create one.

Kenya

ACCESSION TO THE BUDAPEST CONVENTION ON CYBERCRIME

- **Accession to the Budapest Convention** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

  Kenya plans to accede to the Council of Europe's Budapest Convention on Cybercrime, and Parliament is inviting public views by 11 September 2026, according to a 1 September post to the KICTANet mailing list by lawyer Victor Kapiyo. The parliamentary notice itself is not quoted.

KENYA INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS REGULATIONS 2026

- **Register now: Validation forum on Kenya's draft ICT regulations (Sep 15–17)** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

  Kenya's Ministry of Information, Communications and the Digital Economy is holding a virtual validation forum on 15 draft Kenya Information and Communication Regulations, 2026, from 15 to 17 September. The drafts cover licensing, broadcasting, spectrum, tariffs, interconnection, consumer protection, domain names and the Universal Service Fund. Registration is required.

- **Ministry of ICT Hosts Stakeholder Workshop to Validate Proposed Kenya Information and Communications Regulations** — Uasin Gishu News, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT ministry and the Communications Authority held a three-day workshop to validate proposed Kenya Information and Communications Regulations, reported on 23 September 2026. The review covers licensing, spectrum, numbering, interconnection, tariffs, consumer protection, universal service, infrastructure sharing, electronic certification and domain names under the 1998 Act.

STANDALONE DATA-CENTRE LICENCE CATEGORY

- **Proposed Licensing Framework for Data Centres (Consultation Version)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published a consultation in September 2026 proposing a standalone licence for co-location data centres, which are now licensed as Tier 2 network facilities providers. Proposed fees are KSh5,000 to apply, KSh100,000 initially and KSh80,000 or 0.4% of gross turnover a year, for a 15-year term; existing NFP and ASP licensees would need no separate licence.

- **Kenya Proposes Standalone Licence Framework for Data Centres** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya has proposed a standalone Data Centre licence for co-location operators, taking them out of the Network Facilities Provider-Tier 2 category they currently sit under, and opened comment for thirty days from its public notice. The Authority gives visibility over data-centre operations, support for investment and proportionality with comparable jurisdictions as its reasons; the notice itself is not held, so the closing date is unestablished.

- **Kenya proposes introduction of standalone data center license** — Connecting Africa, 10 September 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator opened a 30-day public consultation on a standalone licence for colocation data centres. It says the proposal would give greater regulatory clarity, improve visibility of data-centre operations and support investment, and it follows a broader overhaul of the telecommunications market framework begun in 2025.

NNAI RESOURCES FRAMEWORK CA.F.530:2026

- **Inside new rules for short codes, network equipment and mobile numbers announced by CA** — Pulse Kenya, 8 September 2026

Kenya's Communications Authority issued an enhanced framework for numbering, naming, addressing and identification resources and opened consultations on network equipment specifications and on deactivating and recycling inactive numbers. Short codes move to allocation on a services basis rather than per operator, and the same set of notices carries the Authority's separate proposal for a standalone data centre licence category.

TECHNOPOLIS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

- **Technopolis Development Authority Board fully constituted under new Act** — TechTrends Kenya, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's Technopolis Development Authority board is now complete under the Technopolis Act 2026, in force since 29 May 2026, with the appointment of James Musee Nduna, Yvonne Teresia Ogwang and Yunis M. Omar. Ogwang is the Council of Governors' nominee.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM BILL 2026

- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  The full draft text of Kenya's National Payment System Bill, 2026, which runs to 79 clauses. It sets licence capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million, requires interoperability, provides for open finance, brings virtual asset providers into scope and sets fines of up to Ksh20 million. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

- **Kenya: National Payment System Bill, 2026 proposes comprehensive overhaul of the payments regulatory framework** — Bowmans, 30 September 2026

  Law firm Bowmans summarises Kenya's draft National Payment System Bill, 2026, published by the National Treasury and Central Bank of Kenya with comments due by 9 October 2026. The bill would repeal the 2014 Act, create ten licence categories for payment providers and operators, allow foreign firms to apply and require banks to obtain separate central bank authorisation, with a one-year transition.

CENTRAL BANK OF KENYA (NON-DEPOSIT TAKING CREDIT PROVIDERS) REGULATIONS, 2026

- **The Central Bank of Kenya (Non-Deposit Taking Credit Providers) Regulations, 2026 (Legal Notice No. 191 of 2026)** — Kenya Gazette Supplement No. 234 (Kenya Law), 29 September 2026

  Kenya gazetted the Central Bank of Kenya (Non-Deposit Taking Credit Providers) Regulations, 2026 on 29 September, replacing the 2022 digital credit rules. Licensed lenders pay KSh 500,000 a year, need prior approval to change pricing, must obtain separate consent to process personal data and must have AI lending decisions reviewed by people. Unregulated lenders have six months to apply.

- **CBK raises compliance costs and tightens the rules governing Kenya's growing credit providers** — TechTrends KE, 5 October 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya's final regulations for non-deposit-taking credit providers set a Sh100,000 licence application fee and annual fees of Sh500,000 for licensed and Sh250,000 for registered providers, against Sh5,000 and Sh20,000 under the earlier digital credit regime. A new Sh1 million penalty applies to annual fees unpaid by 31 December.

STATISTICS ACT 2006 (CAP. 112)

- **Senators push Bill to transform KNBS into Kenya Statistics Authority** — People Daily, 12 October 2026

Kenya's Senate finance and budget committee reviewed the draft Statistics Bill 2026 with the national statistics bureau, KNBS, on 12 October 2026. The bill would turn KNBS into a Kenya Statistics Authority as sole producer of official statistics, require a statistics office in every county and set fines of up to KSh 5 million. Senators questioned the authority's independence.

Lesotho

CYBERSECURITY BILL

- **Stakeholders Engage on Cybersecurity Bill 2026** — Government of Lesotho — Department of Information, 23 September 2026

  Lesotho's information and communications ministry, with the Lesotho Communications Authority and UNDP, held a two-day consultation on the Cybersecurity Bill 2026 in Maseru, reported on 23 September 2026. Cabinet split the 2024 Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill into separate cybercrime and cybersecurity bills; the new bill proposes a two-tier regulatory regime and registration of cybersecurity professionals.

ELECTRONIC TRANSACTIONS AND COMMUNICATIONS BILL (2022 BILL, REVISED 2026)

- **MICSTI ON ELECTRONIC TRANSACTIONS, COMMUNICATIONS BILL** — Government of Lesotho, 29 September 2026

  Lesotho's information and communications ministry held a two-day validation workshop in Maseru from 28 September 2026 on the Electronic Transactions and Communications Bill, 2026, supported by UNDP. The bill would give legal recognition to electronic contracts, signatures and records and is aligned with the revised SADC framework; the ministry says Lesotho has no law on electronic transactions.

- **Lesotho revises electronic transactions bill** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Lesotho's ICT ministry held a two-day validation workshop with UNDP on the Electronic Transactions and Communications Bill 2026, a revision of the 2022 bill, to fill the absence of any legal framework for electronic contracts, signatures and records. The bill now moves to the next legislative stages.

Liberia

DRAFT INFRASTRUCTURE REGULATIONS

- **LTA Holds Public Consultation on Draft Infrastructure Regulations** — Liberian Observer, 12 October 2026

  Liberia's telecommunications authority consulted internet service providers, mobile operators and licensees on draft regulations for deploying, sharing, managing and decommissioning telecoms infrastructure. The draft text is not held.

Libya

DECISION 449 OF 2026 ON IMPORTING THROUGH BANKING CHANNELS

- **بوشيحة يصدر قرارًا لتنظيم توريد السلع والبضائع عبر القنوات المصرفية اعتبارًا من 30 سبتمبر** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 7 September 2026

  Libya's economy and trade minister Suhail Bushiha issued Decision No. 449 of 2026 on 7 September, banning the import of goods for trade outside banking channels from 30 September 2026. Customs may release commercial shipments only once banking, trade and customs requirements are met and the shipment's true value is documented; licensed individual traders get an annual import ceiling.

- **Tripoli Chamber of Commerce discusses decision to regulate imports for the purpose of trade** — Libya Herald, 15 September 2026

  The capital's chamber of commerce met on the economy minister's decision 449 of 2026, which from 30 September requires importers and foreign exporters to register on the unified digital trade system. Members questioned whether the date can be met and what the decision will cost them.

Madagascar

CYBERCRIME BILL OVERHAULING THE 2014 LAW

- **Madagascar actualise son arsenal face à la montée des risques numériques** — We are Tech, 1 September 2026

  Madagascar is overhauling its 2014 cybercrime law, with judicial cooperation across borders the central problem where offenders and evidence sit in several countries at once.

- **Cybercriminalite : l''etau se resserre autour des faux comptes** — L'Express de Madagascar, 2 September 2026

  Madagascar's National Assembly was due to vote on a bill reforming the 2014 cybercrime law. Article 17 sets two to five years' prison and fines of Ar5m to Ar50m for running fake-account networks or deceiving people with fake identities, doubled for organised groups. Article 52 makes group administrators and resharers liable for manifestly illegal content they knowingly leave online.

- **Loi sur la cybercriminalite : l''Etat renforce les controles alors que l''acces a l''information reste en suspens** — Madagascar-Tribune, 3 September 2026

  Madagascar's cybercrime bill 042/2026 was due before the National Assembly for adoption. It creates a digital investigation unit, Upin, whose article 75 grants round-the-clock direct technical access to operators' and internet providers' systems, with traceability and judicial safeguards. The paper notes that the access-to-information bill 017/2025 remains adjourned in committee, its plenary debate postponed indefinitely.

- **Madagascar strengthens trust architecture for national digital ID** — Biometric Update, 4 September 2026

  Madagascar's government presented two cybercrime bills to parliament on 28 August 2026, one updating the national cybercrime framework and creating a digital investigation unit (UPIN), the other authorising ratification of the UN Convention against Cybercrime. More than six million people had enrolled in the biometric national ID by June, against a target of 12 million and a production goal of 100,000 cards a day.

- **Cybersurveillance !** — Newsmada, 5 September 2026

  Commentary on the deferral reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests rather than to fight cybercrime, singling out the surveillance powers the bill would create. The Assembly's president said he did not care to imagine what would have followed had the two lead texts not been deferred.

BILL ON ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS AND DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Madagascar Has 80% 4G Coverage, Yet Mobile Internet Remains Out of Reach for Most** — Ecofin Agency, 2 October 2026

  Madagascar's bill on electronic communications and digital infrastructure, submitted on 28 August, still waits for examination by the National Assembly. The article sets it against a market where 4G covers about 80 per cent of the population while mobile internet use stays low.

Mauritius

ROAD TRAFFIC (AMENDMENT) BILL: DIGITAL DRIVING LICENCE AND ONLINE PENALTIES

- **«Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill» : Avinash Ramtohul : «Bâtir un avenir où les services publics suivent l'évolution technologique»** — L'Express (Maurice), 3 September 2026

  Mauritius's ICT minister Avinash Ramtohul said on 3 September 2026 that the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill gives the digital driving licence legal equivalence with the physical one and allows fixed penalties to be paid online or at any court. He said more than 800,000 licence holders are affected and that police will check licence data against a central database.

- **Paiement en ligne des amendes : le système bientôt mis en place** — Le Defi Media Group, 29 September 2026

  Mauritius's ICT minister Avinash Ramtohul said legal provisions allowing traffic fines to be paid online take effect on 30 October, covering only fines not linked to penalty points. The government is still finalising the system; fines can already be paid at any district court.

- **Permis de conduire numérique : une période de transition avant l'entrée en vigueur en 2027** — Le Defi Media Group, 29 September 2026

  Mauritius soft-launched a digital driving licence on the KOREK app for Android and iOS on 29 September 2026, with legal effect from 1 January 2027. From then, drivers stopped at the roadside must show the original or the digital licence; photocopies will not be accepted. Holders are asked to check their data and photo in the app and report errors.

NATIONAL CRIME AGENCY BILL 2026

- **National Crime Agency Bill : ce que prévoit la future agence et jusqu'où iront ses pouvoirs** — Le Défi Media Group, 12 September 2026

  Mauritius published the National Crime Agency Bill 2026 on the National Assembly website, creating a lead agency to investigate financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. It would repeal the Financial Crimes Commission Act 2023 and allow interception and real-time collection of communications data on a judge's order. The Assembly resumes on 20 October and the powers are not yet in force.

- **The National Crime Agency Bill (No. ..... of 2026) — bill text as published by the National Assembly of Mauritius** — National Assembly of Mauritius, 12 September 2026

  Mauritius's National Assembly published the National Crime Agency Bill around 12 September 2026, setting up a lead agency to investigate financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. The bill creates divisions including a Cybercrime Division and a Digital Forensic Laboratory, and repeals the Financial Crimes Commission Act 2023. The bill text carries no date or number.

- **Délibérations du Conseil des Ministres du 11 septembre 2026** — Maurice Info, 13 September 2026

  Mauritius's Cabinet agreed on 11 September 2026 to introduce nine bills establishing a National Crime Agency as the lead investigator of financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. The agency will gather and share intelligence and recover assets, and the Financial Crimes Commission Act will be repealed.

- **2 Senior Legal Experts Issue Warnings Over New Crime Agency Reform** — News Moris, 14 September 2026

  Mauritius's Director of Public Prosecutions, Rashid Ahmine, welcomed most of the National Crime Agency Bill but warned the agency could remain a dead letter without government resources. Under the bill, intrusive surveillance needs a judge's authorisation. The Bar Association president, Antoine Domingue, noted the bill sets no terms of office or removal procedures for appointees.

- **National Crime Agency: How Independent Will It Really Be?** — Mauritius Times, 14 September 2026

A Mauritius Times interview, published on 14 September 2026, examines the proposed National Crime Agency Bill. The commentator argues that constitutional status alone will not secure the agency's independence, and that appointment of its director-general by the President on the advice of a panel, after consulting the Prime Minister and opposition leader, leaves room for political influence.

ELECTRONIC TRANSFERABLE RECORDS UNDER THE BILLS OF EXCHANGE ACT

- **Africa's first electronic bill of exchange goes live under Mauritian law** — Trade Treasury Payments, 16 September 2026

  Mauritius Commercial Bank completed the first electronic bill of exchange under Mauritian law with Export Trading Group, which created five bills in under 30 minutes and transferred them to the bank in under an hour. It is the first live use of the electronic transferable records framework Mauritius adopted through the Finance Act 2025.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT WITH META ON ONLINE SAFETY

- **Meta à Maurice : la sécurité en ligne au cœur des discussions** — L'Express (Maurice), 2 October 2026

  A Meta team is due in Mauritius on 6 and 7 October 2026 for meetings on moderating content in Mauritian Creole, child protection online, identity verification, faster takedowns and whether platforms should have a local presence. Mauritius' ICT ministry and Meta will also discuss a framework agreement on online safety.

- **Government engages Meta to curb online abuse for safer digital environment** — Ministry of Information Technology, Communication and Innovation (Mauritius), 8 October 2026

  Mauritius's ICT ministry met Meta on faster removal of fake accounts, impersonation and illegal content, moderation in Kreol and a local presence for the company. Amendments to the 2021 cybercrime law and age assurance for children were also discussed.

ELECTRONIC TRANSACTIONS (AMENDMENT) ACT 2026

- **From E-Signatures to AI-Driven Contracts: How Mauritius is rewriting the Rules of Digital Transactions** — Appleby, 5 October 2026

  Law firm Appleby reviews Mauritius's Electronic Transactions (Amendment) Act 2026. The Act accepts any reliable electronic signature that identifies the signer and shows intent, gives legal effect to electronic transferable records, and recognises contracts formed by automated systems without human review of each action. Under section 15A, where a certificate or signature originates does not by itself decide its effectiveness.

CYBERSECURITY, CYBERCRIME AND ICT ACT AMENDMENTS

- **Atelier Maurice-Meta : Vers une riposte plus rapide face aux dérives du numérique** — L'Express (Maurice), 8 October 2026

  Mauritius's ICT ministry and Meta held a workshop at Ebene on 7 October 2026 on online abuse, disinformation and deepfakes. Figures presented show reported security incidents rising from 5,221 in 2024 to 6,073 in 2025 and cyberbullying cases from 491 to 702; the government is preparing bills and amendments to the ICT Act on cybersecurity and cybercrime, and wants faster takedown channels with Meta.

- **Avinash Ramtohul : «Il faut apporter un peu de discipline dans les réseaux sociaux»** — L'Express (Maurice), 10 October 2026

Mauritius's ICT minister, Avinash Ramtohul, told L'Express on 10 October 2026 about a two-day working session with Meta on content moderation, reporting and takedown requests. He cited about 20 abuse cases reported a day, a takedown agreement involving the national computer emergency team CERT-MU and Meta verification of MPs' identities, and said Meta could open an office in Mauritius.

Morocco

JOINT ORDER 218.26 ON PASSENGER AND FLIGHT DATA

- **قرار مشترك لوزير الداخلية ووزيرة الاقتصاد والمالية ووزير النقل واللوجيستيك رقم 218.26 صادر في 9 شعبان 1447 (29 يناير 2026) بتحديد لائحة العناصر التي تتكون منها المعلومات المتعلقة بالركاب وبالرحلات التجارية وبأعضاء طاقمها وكذا برحلات الطيران العام (arrêté conjoint n° 218.26, BO n° 7549)** — Royaume du Maroc — Ministère de la Justice, portail Adala (text as published in the Bulletin officiel, édition arabe, n° 7549), 5 October 2026

  Joint arrêté n° 218.26 of 29 January 2026, published in Morocco's Bulletin officiel n° 7549 on 5 October 2026, lists the data airlines must send on passengers, commercial flights, crew and general-aviation flights. It applies decree 2.21.624 of 21 July 2022 and covers identity, contact, payment, frequent-flyer, baggage and travel-document details, with a catch-all for other useful information.

- **Transport aérien : les données des passagers désormais davantage surveillées** — medias24.com, 15 October 2026

  Morocco's Bulletin officiel of 5 October 2026 carries interministerial arrêté n° 218.26 of 29 January 2026, which lists the passenger, booking, payment, baggage, crew and flight data airlines must send to a national processing centre under the DGSN. The stated purpose is preventing terrorism and transnational crime, under decree 2.21.624 and the civil aviation code.

CIVIL PROCEDURE CODE REQUIREMENT OF AN EMAIL ADDRESS FOR LEGAL-PERSON PARTIES

- **غياب البريد الإلكتروني يعرقل مساطر تحصيل الديون أمام المحاكم التجارية** — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Casablanca's commercial court of first instance rejected a payment-order application for MAD 376,552 because it omitted the debtor company's email address, applying Article 234 of Morocco's Civil Procedure Code, which requires an email for any legal-person party, Hespress reported on 13 October 2026. Creditors without debtors' email addresses face similar refusals. The order's date is not given.

Mozambique

COMMUNICATIONS CONSUMER PROTECTION AND DISPUTE REGULATIONS

- **Relatório de Defesa do Consumidor dos Serviços de Comunicações 2025** — Autoridade Reguladora das Comunicações (INCM), Moçambique, 9 September 2026

  Mozambique's communications regulator, INCM, reported 391,723 telecoms complaints in 2025, up about 44% from 271,993 in 2024, with 95.2% of closed complaints resolved; postal complaints fell from 276 to 258. Vodacom logged 115,100 complaints and Movitel 87,428. INCM named Tmcel, Teledata, TMT and StarTimes for closer follow-up, and two postal operators filed no returns.

- **Mozambique telecoms complaints surge 44%** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026

  Mozambique's communications regulator recorded 391,723 consumer complaints in 2025, up 44 per cent on 2024, with 372,846 of the telecommunications complaints resolved and an average satisfaction index of 82 per cent. It attributes much of the rise to better recording rather than worse service, one operator's logged complaints having gone from 213 to 24,036 on a new incident-tracking system.

TELECOMMUNICATIONS TRAFFIC CONTROL REGULATIONS (DECREE 48/2025)

- **Mozambique's Internet Shutdown Case: African Courts Draw a Line on Executive Power** — Collaboration on International ICT Policy for East and Southern Africa (CIPESA), 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  Mozambique's Constitutional Council ruled in July that a government must first have lawful authority to order an internet shutdown before it can justify one. An advocacy organisation reads the ruling as requiring proof both that the power was lawfully created and that it was exercised by a legally authorised body, and sets it against a wider continental pattern of shutdowns.

POSTAL SECURITY REGULATION

- **Governo aprova novo regulamento para reforcar a Seguranca Postal e proteger o Comercio Electronico** — MZNews, 16 September 2026

  Mozambique's Council of Ministers approved a Postal Security Regulation on 15 September 2026, setting controls against theft, fraud and cyber threats to the postal network as e-commerce parcels increase.

LAW REGULATING ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN EDUCATION

- **Governo prepara lei para regular IA na educação** — Integrity Magazine, 17 September 2026

  Mozambique's education ministry says its law regulating the use of artificial intelligence in education is almost ready and will reach the Council of Ministers before the end of 2026, covering every institution from primary schooling to higher education with all of them consulted. The text is still being drafted and is not published.

Namibia

REGULATIONS ON ACCREDITATION OF SECURITY PRODUCTS, SERVICES AND PROVIDERS

- **Regulations regarding Accreditation of Security Products and Services and Providers of such Products and Services (Electronic Transactions Act 4 of 2019)** — Legal Assistance Centre (LAC) Namibia, reproducing General Notice 953 of 2025 (Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia), 17 December 2025

  CRAN's regulations on the accreditation of security products, services and certification service providers under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019 came into force on 15 June 2026. They set out which products and services need accreditation and how providers apply, and are the instrument under which the home affairs ministry later became Namibia's first accredited certification service provider.

FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS AND MARKETS ACT AND NAMFISA ACT

- **NAMFISA launches FinTech Square 2026 event to accelerate local innovation** — Namibia Economist, 18 September 2026

  The Namibia Financial Supervisory Authority announced its FinTech Square 2026 event for 14 October in Windhoek, with the Bank of Namibia and other partners. The event will launch the second cohort of NAMFISA's regulatory sandbox, covering crowdfunding and peer-to-peer lending, after a first cohort on microlending. Twelve exhibitors from the non-banking financial sector are to be selected.

- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026

  The head of Namibia's financial regulator, Kenneth Matomola, said fintech could help with jobs and financial inclusion now that the Financial Institutions and Markets Act and a new Namfisa Act are in force. Both took effect on 1 May 2026. He cited youth unemployment of 44.4% in the 2023 labour force survey.

Niger

DRAFT ORDINANCE ON THE ELECTRONIC PRESS

- **Conclusions du Conseil des ministres du jeudi 10 septembre 2026** — Gouvernement du Niger, 10 September 2026

  Niger's Council of Ministers adopted on 10 September 2026 a draft ordinance creating a legal regime for the electronic press and a draft decree on press correspondents and accreditation of foreign media. The government said online media had lacked a legal framework, preventing the communication observatory ONC from regulating them. The decree gives the ONC an opinion on foreign-correspondent accreditation.

- **Niger's Media Adjustment: Regulation, Control, and the Shrinking Newsroom in the Sahel** — ModernGhana, 15 September 2026

  The council of ministers approved an overhaul of the media regulatory framework on 10 September, tightening accreditation for foreign correspondents and carrying a draft ordinance requiring online press publishers to be identified, with legal responsibility on digital newsrooms for what they carry.

ARRETE ON COMMERCIAL WI-FI ZONE PROVISION

- **Le CFAIC plaide pour une réglementation adaptée aux réalités des Wifi Zones au Niger - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 20 September 2026

  Niger's collective of community internet access providers (CFAIC-Niger) called on 20 September 2026 for Wi-Fi Zone rules that operators can realistically meet. It welcomed the order placing Wi-Fi Zones under a declaration regime but contested provisions on equipment, file-review fees, annual royalties and technical limits, and asked for six months to comply.

Nigeria

NIMC ACT 2026

- **How NIMC emerges Nigeria's National Trust Authority under new Act 2026** — Business and Transport, 3 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Identity Management Commission presented its new Act, signed by President Tinubu on 26 June 2026 to replace the 2007 Act, at a roundtable with online publishers in Lagos on 28 August. The Act makes the commission a foundational identity and data exchange agency; about 140 million people hold a NIN, and enrolment now takes one hour rather than seven days.

FCCPC CONSUMER-PROTECTION PENALTY AGAINST META

- **Après son amende de 220 millions de dollars, Meta tente de négocier un compromis avec Abuja** — Africa Intelligence, 14 September 2026

  Meta is negotiating a settlement with Nigeria's consumer protection commission over its US$220 million fine after a first appeal was rejected, Africa Intelligence reports. No terms or timetable are given.

CBN PAYMENTS DATA-LOCALISATION DIRECTIVE

- **Nigeria's data localisation deadline is testing its financial infrastructure** — TechCabal, 17 September 2026

  Nigeria's 1 January 2027 deadline for payment data localisation is pushing banks and fintechs to rethink how they store and secure customer and transaction data. The central bank frames the objective as local oversight of core financial records rather than separation from global providers, and the risks raised include offshore backups and several institutions concentrating on the same domestic facility.

- **Nigeria's central bank data localisation push is about more than local servers** — TechCabal, 29 September 2026

  A Central Bank of Nigeria supervision director said the payments-data localisation rule due on 1 January 2027 is about resilience and recoverability, not where servers sit. Further implementation guidance is being prepared, and institutions were told not to wait for it.

- **Split-cloud architecture puts Nigerian banks under new pressure** — BusinessDay (Nigeria), 4 October 2026

  Nigerian banks and large fintechs face the central bank's 1 January 2027 deadline for storing payment transaction data in the country. Cloud providers say some may keep applications on foreign clouds and host the regulated data locally, an arrangement the central bank has not ruled on.

NIGERIAN FINTECH REGULATORY COMMISSION BILL (HB.2389)

- **One Regulator or Many? Inside the Bill That Could Rewrite How Nigeria Licenses Its 430 Fintechs** — BusinessTech Nigeria, 9 October 2026

  BusinessTech Nigeria explains the Nigerian Fintech Regulatory Commission Bill 2025 (HB.2389), which would create a single regulator to license and supervise fintech services now split between the central bank, the SEC and other agencies. The bill passed second reading in the House of Representatives on 28 October 2025 and had a public hearing on 2 March 2026; it remains pending.

LAGOS STATE INNOVATION BILL

- **Lagos Backs AI Builders Over AI Buyers at the Nigeria Innovation Summit 11.0** — TechTrends Africa, 10 October 2026

  Lagos State's special adviser on technology, Ganiyu Oseni, delivered Governor Babajide Sanwo-Olu's address to the 11th Nigeria Innovation Summit in Lagos on 6 October 2026, saying Nigeria should build AI rather than depend on computing done in Europe. The address cited US$3.9 billion of venture capital in five years, more than one million connections on the state's fibre network and a planned innovation bill.

INTERNET CODE OF PRACTICE 2026

- **NCC Hosts Stakeholders To Chart Course For Future Of Internet, Launches Working Group** — Independent Newspaper Nigeria, 15 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator launched an Internet Governance Working Group at its symposium in Ikeja on 15 October 2026. It said it will publish implementation guidelines and FAQs for the Internet Code of Practice and run workshops for licensees not yet ready to comply.

- **NCC survey finds gaps in licensees' readiness for Internet code** — Vanguard, 15 October 2026

  An NCC survey found only two of 19 licensees fully ready to implement Nigeria's Internet Code of Practice 2026, with nine partly ready and five not prepared. Licensees named the cybersecurity and AI provisions as the hardest and asked for guidance and reporting templates.

Senegal

CRITICAL-INFRASTRUCTURE PROTECTION LEGAL FRAMEWORK

- **Cyberattaques récurrentes : le Sénégal se dote d'une Autorité nationale de Cybersécurité** — AtlanticActu, 1 September 2026

Senegal's National Assembly adopted the bill on protecting critical information infrastructure and digital security, creating a national cybersecurity authority with legal personality and a special status, backed by a national response team. Adopted is not promulgated.

EXTENSION OF THE VALIDITY OF THE 2016 ECOWAS BIOMETRIC IDENTITY CARDS

- **Cartes d'identité biométriques de 2016 : vers une prorogation de la validité** — Seneweb, 24 September 2026

  Senegal's Interior Ministry has begun a legislative process to extend the validity of the first ECOWAS biometric identity cards, issued in 2016 and nearing expiry, the head of the file automation directorate, Ibrahima Dieng, said on 24 September 2026. The text has been in committee at the National Assembly. The length of the extension and the cards covered are not yet set, and normal renewal remains open.

- **Assemblée : Coup de Théâtre, le projet de loi sur la carte d'identité retourne en commission** — Senego, 29 September 2026

  Senegal's National Assembly sent bill 21-2026, amending the law on the ECOWAS biometric identity card, back to committee on 29 September 2026 on a motion by the Law Committee chair, Abdoulaye Tall. He raised the bill's effect on voter cards, the financing and procurement of card renewal, and the custody of citizens' data held by foreign operators.

- **Cartes d'identité : Mouhamadou Moukhtar Cissé explique la prorogation exceptionnelle** — Senegal Direct, 29 September 2026

  Senegal's Interior Minister Mouhamadou Moukhtar Cissé told the National Assembly's law committee that a bill extending the validity of some biometric ECOWAS identity cards is needed because the contract with Malaysian supplier Iris expires on 21 May 2027, before all cards can be renewed. About 700,000 cards are due for renewal. Card production resumed on 1 April 2026 after a cyberattack.

- **Passeports et cartes d'identité : Vers la fin du contrat avec l'opérateur malaisien et le recours à l'expertise nationale** — vipeoples.net, 30 September 2026

  Senegal's National Assembly took in plenary on 29 September a bill amending the ECOWAS biometric identity card law. In committee the interior minister confirmed an attack on the directorate that runs identity files, announced a security audit and a national data centre for civil-status and identity data, and said card and passport production would pass to Senegalese firms as the Malaysian contract runs out.

Sierra Leone

DIGITAL GOVERNMENT BILL

- **Government Reviews Security of Children s Vaccination Data** — Sierra Loaded, 11 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications and technology ministry, with UNICEF and the Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure, held a three-day workshop on safeguards for children's data in connected government systems, reported on 11 September 2026. Officials from 16 ministries worked on birth registration, vaccination records, education data and social protection, including who may access vaccination records and where breaches could occur.

Somalia

DRAFT PENAL CODE REPLACING THE 1962 CODE

- **Somalia Penal Code Reform Targets Cybercrime and Emerging Digital Offences** — Goobjoog English, 14 October 2026

> Somalia's parliament is reviewing a draft Penal Code to replace the 1962 code, adding provisions for offences involving digital platforms and information systems. The Speaker of the House of the People discussed it with the judiciary committee and the justice minister. No timetable for a final vote has been announced.

South Africa

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM BILL

- **National Payment System Bill: Sarb readies overhaul** — TechCentral, 1 September 2026

  South Africa's Reserve Bank governor said the National Payment System Bill will soon go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from an entity-based model to an activity-based one — the change that would open payment licensing beyond banks.

REGULATOR'S POWER TO CONDONE A LATE LICENCE RENEWAL

- **ICASA turns to ConCourt to clarify its powers** — ITWeb South Africa, 2 September 2026

  ICASA has asked the Constitutional Court to settle whether it may condone a late licence-renewal notice from a class licensee, having lost the question in both the Pretoria High Court and the Supreme Court of Appeal to Open Heaven, a Hammanskraal community radio station that filed two weeks late. The regulator reads section 11(9) of the Electronic Communications Act as granting that power only for individual licences, and section 19(2) as deliberately withholding it for class licences; Open Heaven argues the Act leaves latitude where good cause is shown. The court heard the matter on 27 August and has not ruled.

OPERATOR ASSOCIATION EXEMPTION TO SHARE INFRASTRUCTURE PLANNING DATA

- **SA telco giants seek competition waiver in rural broadband rollout** — Sunday Times (TimesLIVE), 5 September 2026

  South Africa's main telecoms operators, through the Association of Communications and Technology, have asked the competition authorities for an exemption to share limited planning information on passive infrastructure such as towers and ducts in rural and underserved areas. Coordination would run through an independent third party to split build costs. The association represents Vodacom, MTN, Telkom, Cell C, Liquid and Rain.

- **South Africa Pushes Subsea Cable, AI and Digital Skills Agenda to Expand Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  South Africa's operator association has asked the Competition Commission for a five-year exemption letting Vodacom, MTN, Telkom, Cell C, Rain and Liquid share limited infrastructure planning information through an independent third party, to find connectivity gaps and avoid duplicated build. The communications minister, who called the proposal encouraging for rural areas and townships, also argued that disruption to Middle East routes gives the country an opening as an alternative submarine cable hub.

ELECTORAL CODE OF CONDUCT ON COUNTERING DISINFORMATION

- **IEC gazettes code to tackle election disinformation** — ITWeb South Africa, 9 September 2026

  South Africa's Electoral Commission has gazetted a Disinformation Code for the local government elections on 4 November, binding political parties, candidates and anyone acting on their instruction or for reward across all election-related communication, online or offline, paid or unpaid. Parties and candidates must check information before sharing it, publicly retract and correct anything false within 36 hours of becoming aware of it, label AI-generated content and political advertising, and report online disinformation to Real411 within 36 hours; fake accounts, bot networks, coordinated inauthentic behaviour, doxing and cyberbullying are

prohibited, as is disinformation targeting the commission or its staff. Contravention carries the sanctions applying to the Electoral Code of Conduct under the Municipal Electoral Act 27 of 2000, and parties will undertake to comply at the signing ceremony on 23 September; the source gives no gazette number or date for the final code.

POSITION ON AGE ASSURANCE FOR UNDER-16S

- **South Africa rejects blanket social media age verification for under-16s** — Biometric Update, 10 September 2026

  South Africa's communications minister told parliament the government is not pursuing any blanket policy restricting under-16s from social media, saying platforms should instead strengthen their own protections against harmful content. The position separates the country from a growing number of states, several of them African, adopting age-assurance requirements.

- **South Africa has no plan to ban under-16s from social media** — IOL, 16 September 2026

  South Africa's Department of Communications and Digital Technologies said on 16 September 2026 that it has no legislation planned to bar under-16s from social media. Minister Solly Malatsi said there is no clear evidence such bans keep children offline, and the department will instead strengthen the Film and Publication Board and NEMISA and build digital literacy. Parliament's portfolio committee is considering summoning the platforms over online harms.

FILM AND PUBLICATION BOARD ENFORCEMENT UNDER THE FILMS AND PUBLICATIONS ACT

- **Online content crackdown nets R16m in fines** — ITWeb South Africa, 17 September 2026

  South Africa's Film and Publication Board imposed R16.175 million in fines on distributors found non-compliant with the Films and Publications Act, most of the content distributed online. The board says its enforcement reaches distributors based abroad.

AMENDED COURT RULES FOR ACCESS-TO-INFORMATION APPLICATIONS

- **Media Statement: Justice Committee Approves Publication of Proposed Amended PAIA Court Rules to Enhance Transparency and Access to Justice** — Parliament of South Africa, 23 September 2026

  South Africa's parliamentary justice committee agreed on 23 September 2026 that the Department of Justice may publish proposed amended court rules for applications under the Promotion of Access to Information Act. The draft rules standardise section 78 applications across all courts, require sworn section 80 representations five days before hearings, and repeal the previous PAIA rules. They are not yet in force.

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION AND REGISTRATION BILL

- **Problem with plan for digital IDs in South Africa** — MyBroadband, 6 October 2026

  South Africa's Home Affairs missed its first-quarter target to sign a work order starting procurement of digital ID hosting infrastructure, its quarterly report to Parliament's committee says. It also missed revising the National Identification Registration Bill for public comment, and now aims to finalise the procurement in the second quarter.

South Sudan

ELECTRONIC MONEY REGULATION 2017 (AMENDMENT 2025)

- **BoSS Sets Strict USD Caps on Mobile Money** — Access Radio Yei, 1 September 2026

The Bank of South Sudan's amended electronic money rules have taken effect, setting three customer-verification tiers with daily limits of SSP 1.625 million, 6.5 million and 13 million. Every digital payment platform must connect to the National Payment System through a licensed switch, keep customer funds in trust accounts spread across banks, and resolve complaints within seven days.

Tanzania

ACCREDITATION OF CONTENT CREATORS DOING JOURNALISTIC WORK

- **Content creators in Tanzania face media rules as role in news grows** — The Citizen, 17 September 2026

  Tanzania's journalists accreditation board said content creators doing journalistic work fall under the Media Services Act, so that none may report news or conduct interviews without accreditation, which requires at least a diploma. The board also said a creator doing journalism must register their platform with the communications regulator as a media outlet.

DIGITAL SERVICE TAX ON FOREIGN DIGITAL SERVICE PROVIDERS

- **The Citizen Budget 2026/27** — Ministry of Finance, United Republic of Tanzania, 22 September 2026

  Tanzania's finance ministry published its Citizen Budget for 2026/27, a 34-page plain-language account of spending of TZS 54.50 trillion, revenue sources, deficit and financing. Its revenue measures include raising the digital service tax on foreign digital service providers from 2% to 3%. The document carries no issue date.

BUSINESS LICENSING (AMENDMENT) REGULATIONS 2026

- **Digital Payments Now a Business Licensing Requirement** — FB Attorneys, 9 October 2026

  Law firm FB Attorneys notes that Tanzania's Business Licensing (Amendment) Regulations, 2026, published as Government Notice 158N on 30 June and in force from 1 July 2026, require applicants for new or renewed business licences to show they can take digital payments, such as Lipa Namba or TANQR. Businesses in minerals, livestock, agricultural produce, timber and fisheries must also show a bank account.

Togo

RATIFICATION OF THE UNION BANKING COMMISSION CONVENTION

- **Les grandes decisions du Conseil des ministres du 07 Septembre 2026** — Presidence du Conseil de la Republique togolaise, 8 September 2026

  Togo's Council of Ministers on 7 September 2026 adopted a bill to ratify the revised convention governing the West African Monetary Union's Banking Commission. The revision extends the Commission's supervision to all regulated institutions, not only credit institutions, and covers resolution and depositor protection. The Council also adopted a bill on banking regulation in Togo.

REVIEW OF THE 2009 CIVIL REGISTRATION LAW

- **État civil au Togo : le MATGLAC renforce les capacités des acteurs pour une réforme du cadre juridique** — Le Visionnaire, 15 September 2026

  The territorial administration ministry ran a three-day technical workshop from 8 September for the cell supporting the review of the 2009 civil status law, a review formally opened on 21 August.

REVISION OF THE 2020 PRESS AND COMMUNICATION CODE TO COVER ONLINE CONTENT CREATORS

- **Régulation du numérique : La HARC engage le dialogue avec les créateurs de contenus** — Togo-Presse, 22 September 2026

Togo's communication regulator HARC held its first official meeting with content creators, bloggers and influencers in Lomé on 22 September 2026, citing its remit over social-media content under article 78 of the 2024 Constitution. HARC's president said social-media advertising should in principle need its prior approval, and the communication ministry said the 2020 press and communication code will be revised to cover these actors.

Tunisia

COMPULSORY E-INVOICING (ARTICLE 53)

- **Tunisie: Fiscalité - Le conseiller Anis Ben Saïd détaille l'obligation de la facturation électronique pour 380 000 professions libérales** — allAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Tunisian tax adviser Anis Ben Saïd told Diwan FM on 19 September 2026 that electronic invoicing is now mandatory for about 380,000 liberal-profession providers, including doctors, lawyers, engineers and accountants, with registration on the platform open since 15 September. Invoices are validated through the mobile digital identity and cannot be changed once signed; errors require a credit note.

- **جريدة الصباح نيوز - عمادة الأطباء تعلن تمسكها بالتحفظ على تطبيق منظومة الفوترة الإلكترونية على القطاع الطبي بصيغتها الحالية** — Assabah News, 3 October 2026

  Tunisia's National Council of the Order of Physicians said on 3 October 2026 that it maintains its objection to applying electronic invoicing to doctors in its current form. It argues that a 2026 tax note extended Article 53 of the Finance Law to non-commercial professions without legal basis, and cites medical secrecy and patient data protection. A proposed amendment it helped draft is still awaited.

CENTRAL BANK CIRCULAR 2026-10 ON PAYMENT ESTABLISHMENTS

- **Circulaire n°2026-10 relative aux établissements de paiement** — Banque Centrale de Tunisie, 25 September 2026

  Tunisia's central bank issued Circular 2026-10 on payment institutions on 25 September 2026, replacing Circular 2018-16 with effect three months after publication. It sets three tiers of client payment accounts, allows remote account opening with reliable identity checks, caps cash transfers at 3,000 dinars per operation and requires an annual IT security audit by a firm certified by the national cybersecurity agency.

REMOTE-WORK BILL

- **وزير الشؤون الاجتماعية.. مشروع قانون العمل عن بعد جاهز وفي طور استكمال مراحله الإدارية الأخيرة** — Al Chourouk, 8 October 2026

  Tunisia's social affairs minister Issam Lahmar said on 8 October 2026 that the remote-work bill is ready and completing its final administrative stages. He said the ministry has also studied the platform economy and prepared a legal text on it, and is working on core labour-law principles and mediation in labour disputes. No date for submission to parliament is given.

Uganda

UCC ORDER SUSPENDING PUBLIC INTERNET

- **Uganda Communications Commission explains internet shutdown** — New Vision, 7 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator published the text of its suspension directive: public internet, new SIM sales and outbound data roaming stopped, mobile VPNs disabled, a whitelisted exclusion list from referral hospitals to railway signalling, and restoration only on written notice.

DIGITAL LENDING PLATFORM REGULATION

- **Uganda's central bank to probe claims mobile money users are paying off strangers' loans** — Kikubolane, 15 September 2026

  Bank of Uganda governor Michael Atingi-Ego told a parliamentary committee on 14 September 2026 that the bank will investigate claims that mobile money operators it supervises, MTN and Airtel, helped digital lenders recover unpaid loans from the wallets of people listed as guarantors without consent. Standalone digital lenders fall under the finance ministry, not the central bank.

- **MTN, Airtel deny deducting customers' money without consent** — PML Daily, 16 September 2026

  MTN Uganda and Airtel Uganda told Parliament's public enterprises committee, reported on 16 September 2026, that they do not deduct customers' money without consent or require loan guarantors, and that they only provide platforms for licensed lenders. They asked the Uganda Communications Commission to block unlicensed lending apps. The committee has summoned 58 online lending companies over recoveries from people named as guarantors without consent.

RESTRICTION OF REPEAT ONLINE OFFENDERS

- **Uganda proposes stricter measures against serial cyber offenders** — CAJ News Africa, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator said it is working with parliament on a framework allowing targeted denial of service to repeat abusers of cyberspace, its director likening the measure to withdrawing a driving licence. No bill, offence definition or appeal route is published.

UCC ENFORCEMENT AGAINST UNLICENSED PUBLIC WI-FI

- **UCC Reviews Crackdown on Unauthorised Wi-Fi Operators After Complaints** — Nile Post, 12 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator said it is reviewing its enforcement against unauthorised Wi-Fi and hotspot resellers after complaints from operators. A public notice was promised within the week.

- **Press Release on Illegal Wi-Fi Hotspots** — Uganda Communications Commission, 13 October 2026

  The Uganda Communications Commission said on 13 October 2026 that about 4,000 unlicensed operators resell public Wi-Fi at UGX 1,000 per GB against UGX 2,000 from licensed providers, costing about UGX 148 billion a year in tax. The Uganda Revenue Authority will block equipment imports by unlicensed operators, and a nationwide exercise to take down installations and seize routers is imminent.

E-COMMERCE TRUST MARK AND ONLINE CONSUMER REDRESS

- **MINISTRY OF TRADE TO INTRODUCE DIGITAL MARK FOR ONLINE CONSUMER PROTECTION** — Uganda Media Centre, 15 October 2026

  Uganda's trade minister Sanjay Tanna told a press conference on 15 October 2026 that his ministry will introduce a digital mark for online sellers to protect consumers, expected within a few months. The ministry is also building a database of sellers.

- **Uganda Champions AU single digital market plan to boost cross-border trade** — Daily Monitor, 16 October 2026

  Ahead of a technology and intellectual property symposium on 22-23 October, Uganda's trade minister set out plans to back the AU's single digital market, including a trust mark for vetted online sellers and rules giving online buyers redress, to be rolled out in the EAC first. A Jumia-led e-commerce industry association and a call for a Consumer Protection Act were also presented.

Zambia

REVOCATION OF AN OPERATOR'S LICENCES

- **ZICTA kicks out Zedmobile from Zambia's telecom market over regulatory non-compliance** — Zambia Monitor, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator revoked an operator's network and service licences with effect from 14 September, citing persistent failures to meet regulatory, operational and financial obligations after considering the operator's representations.

ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS AND TRANSACTIONS ACT NO. 4 OF 2021

- **Gov't Reviews Electronic Communications and Transactions Act** — Efficacy News, 30 September 2026

  Zambia's technology ministry opened stakeholder consultations on amending the Electronic Communications and Transactions Act of 2021, approved in principle by Cabinet in September 2025. The changes would strengthen the national public key infrastructure under ZICTA and add appeal mechanisms.

Zimbabwe

STATUTORY INSTRUMENT ON E-HAILING SERVICES

- **InDrive, Bolt providing affordable, dignified services – says government, as e-hailing services get five-month reprieve** — NewZimbabwe, 9 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's Cabinet granted e-hailing platforms including Bolt, InDrive and Tap & Go a five-month moratorium, Information Minister Soda Zhemu announced on 9 September 2026. During it the government will develop a self-regulating framework for drivers and passenger safety and register the businesses, with a view to bringing platforms and drivers into the tax net.

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